

PART 13

Cheat sheet

One page for the waiting room. The reasoning behind each line is in Parts 9, 11 and 12.

Figure 32 The cheat sheet on one page

THE PROTOCOL: STEADY, SORT, ACT, CLOSE (45 TO 75 SECONDS)



THE PRIORITY LADDER: A HIGHER RUNG ALWAYS WINS



THE PROTOCOL, IN WORDS

1 Steady (0 to 8 s). One slow breath out. Repeat the problem in one line. Ask one question only if a missing fact changes the answer.

2 Sort (8 to 25 s). Say what is at stake and rank it on the ladder. Separate what you know from what you would need to find out.

3 Act (25 to 60 s). The first concrete step, who you tell, and by when. Then the route that still meets the goal.

4 Close (60 to 75 s). The outcome, the record you leave, the follow-up. Then stop.

Deloitte's Code calls its method ACT: Assess, Consider and Consult, Take action. "Speaking up is taking action!" [S340]

THE NEVER LIST

- Put client data into a public AI tool [S340] [S345]
- Send AI output you have not checked line by line [S347][S388]
- Overstate your experience to a client [S340]
- Move, pad or under-record hours [S340]
- Make management decisions for a Deloitte audit client [S364]
- Reuse one client's information for another, or tip anyone off [S340][S359]
- Accept lavish hospitality during a live bid [S357]
- Delete files when a matter may be investigated [S390]
- Pass a failed test, or drop a red risk to please a sponsor **INFERRED**
- Use someone else's login, or keep access after you leave a project [S363]
- Use AI in Deloitte's assessments or interviews [S351]

EIGHT FRAME-BREAKS, AND THE COUNTER

After your first answer, the interviewer tests whether it holds. Keep the same priority order; change a step only for a new fact.

- 1. Interruption.** Finish one sentence, then go where they lead. Do not restart the whole answer.
- 2. Flat contradiction.** Name the evidence that would change your view; keep the view if it is absent [S340].
- 3. Silence.** Count three seconds, then offer to go deeper on one part. Never retract to fill the gap.
- 4. Escalation.** Higher stakes mean a more senior person to consult, not a faster climb-down [S340].
- 5. Authority squeeze.** Agree the goal, decline the method, offer an alternative with a time.
- 6. False choice.** Name the third route: deliver part on time, flag the rest, raise it early.
- 7. Knowledge trap.** Say you do not know the detail, state the principle, say who you would check with [S340].
- 8. Invitation to badmouth.** Decline warmly. Talk only about what you did and would do differently.

LINES TO HAVE READY

- "I'll keep it legal and honest first, do right by the client second, follow the process and leave a record third, and go as fast as those three allow."
- "Let me confirm with my manager and come back to you by three o'clock."
- "Here is what I know, what I do not know, and what I would do next."
- "That is outside what we agreed. Let me log it and check how we fit it in." [S377]
- "I would only use firm-approved AI tools and verify every source." [S3]
- "I got that wrong. Here is the fix, and here is who I have told."

NUMBERS, IF ASKED

- Deloitte UK FY26 (year to 31 May 2026): **£5.81bn**, +2%, UK and Switzerland consolidated (UK £5,014m; Swiss £795m) [S407][S88]
- UK T&T **£1.75bn**, +4%, the largest UK business; Tax & Legal £1.36bn; Audit & Assurance £998m; SR&T Advisory £913m [S407]
- Profit £899m, +14%; £1.125m per equity partner; 784 equity partners; about 25,000 people [S407]
- Global FY26: US\$74.5bn, +3.8% local currency; T&T slowest at +2.5% [S70]
- Deloitte EMEA from 1 June 2026: about €20bn, 132,000 people [S277]
- Claude for 470,000+ people, 15,000 to be certified [S116]
- UK consulting market £21.8bn, +3% in 2025 [S150]

QUESTIONS TO ASK (PICK TWO)

- "T&T grew slowest globally but fastest in the UK. What is the UK doing differently?" [S70][S407]
- "With a Chief AI Officer now on the UK Executive, how has your own work changed?" [S274]
- "What checks does your team use when GenAI helps draft a client deliverable?" [S316]
- "With the independence rules, where does your team find most of its integrated work?" [S314]

THE 30-SECOND WHY DELOITTE

"I want to start where the shape of the firm helps me learn. Deloitte keeps audit, tax, advisory and technology in one partnership. In FY25 T&T revenue fell 10%, but the firm fell only 1% [S89][S305]. That stability pays for £180m of technology investment and a new Chief AI Officer [S407]. In FY26 T&T was the fastest-growing UK business, on ERP, cyber and human capital work. That is the work I want to learn." [S407]

Sources: [S407] Deloitte UK FY26 results (30 Sep 2026); [S88] FY26 metrics; [S70] Deloitte Global FY26 (24 Sep 2026); [S340] Global Code (Oct 2025). The protocol, ladder and counters are this pack's synthesis of the Code's ACT method **INFERRED**; Part 11 gives the full reasoning. Read: the strip is the method; the boxes are what you say.

Sources for the cheat sheet

IDs match Part 15 of the full interview pack. All accessed 4 October 2026.

S3 Deloitte UK (ATS), "TST Industrial Placement, Belfast (25056)" (live Oct 2026). <https://apply.deloitte.co.uk/UKEarlyCareers/JobDetail/Technology-Strategy-Consulting-Technology-Strategy-Transformation/25056>

S70 Deloitte Global, "Deloitte reports FY2026 revenue" (2026-09-24). <https://www.deloitte.com/global/en/about/press-room/global-revenue-announcement.html>

S88 Deloitte UK, "Business and ESG performance metrics for FY26 (PDF)" (2026-09). <https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-zone2/uk/en/docs/about/2026/deloitte-uk-annual-review-2026-business-and-esg-performance-metrics.pdf>

S89 Deloitte UK, "Business and ESG Performance Metrics for FY25 (PDF)" (2025-09). <https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-zone2/uk/en/docs/about/2025/deloitte-uk-annual-review-2025-business-and-esg-performance-metrics.pdf>

S116 Anthropic, "Deloitte and Anthropic partnership" (2025-10-06). <https://www.anthropic.com/news/deloitte-anthropic-partnership>

S150 Consultancy.uk, "Rising exports drove UK consulting industry growth in 2025" (2026-07 (MCA report pub. 6 Jul 2026 per article)). <https://www.consultancy.uk/news/44832/rising-exports-drove-uk-consulting-industry-growth-in-2025>

S274 Deloitte UK press room, "Deloitte UK appoints first Chief AI Officer" (1 Jun 2026). <https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-appoints-first-chief-ai-officer-2026.html>

S277 Deloitte EMEA press room, "Deloitte announces the launch of an EMEA firm" (23 Feb 2026). <https://www.deloitte.com/emea/en/press-room/deloitte-announces-the-launch-of-an-emea-firm.html>

S305 Scottish Financial News, "Profits rise 4% at Deloitte UK despite first revenue decline in 15 years" (2025). <https://www.scottishfinancialnews.com/articles/profits-rise-4-at-deloitte-uk-despite-first-revenue-decline-in-15-years>

S314 ICAS / ACCA / Accountancy Daily, "FRC strengthens auditor independence requirements; FRC bans majority of non-audit services" (2019-12). <https://www.icas.com/news-insights-events/news/ethics/frc-strengthens-auditor-independence-requirements>

S316 The Register, "Deloitte refunds Australian government over AI in report" (2025-10-06). https://www.theregister.com/2025/10/06/deloitte_ai_report_australia/

S340 Deloitte Global, "Global Principles of Business Conduct: It starts with integrity (PDF)" (Oct 2025). <https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-shared/docs/global-principles-of-business-conduct.pdf>

S345 Deloitte UK, "Audit Transparency Report 2025 (accessible PDF)" (2025 (FY to 31 May 2025)). <https://www.deloitte.com/content/dam/assets-zone2/uk/en/docs/about/2025/deloitte-uk-annual-review-2025-audit-transparency-report-accessible.pdf>

S347 Deloitte US, "Trusted generative AI (Abrash and Ammanath)" (n.d.). <https://www.deloitte.com/us/en/what-we-do/capabilities/applied-artificial-intelligence/articles/trusted-generative-ai.html>

S351 Deloitte UK, "Integrity & AI guidance (early careers)" (n.d. (live 2026)). <https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/careers/early-careers/integrity-guidance.html>

S357 Ministry of Justice / gov.uk, "The Bribery Act 2010: Guidance (s.9)" (2011). <https://assets.publishing.service.gov.uk/media/5d80cfc3ed915d51e9aff85a/bribery-act-2010-guidance.pdf>

S359 legislation.gov.uk, "UK MAR Article 10" (2014). <https://www.legislation.gov.uk/eur/2014/596/article/10>

S363 legislation.gov.uk, "Computer Misuse Act 1990, section 1 (and s.17)" (1990 (revised)). <https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/1990/18/section/1>

S364 Financial Reporting Council, "Revised Ethical Standard 2024 (PDF)" (2024 (effective 15 Dec 2024)). https://www.frc.org.uk/documents/6703/Revised_Ethical_Standard_2024_orZHKLq.pdf

S377 APM, "What is change control?" (live 2026). <https://www.apm.org.uk/resources/what-is-project-management/what-is-change-control/>

S388 The Guardian, "Deloitte to pay money back to Albanese government after using AI in \$440,000 report" (6 Oct 2025). <https://www.theguardian.com/australia-news/2025/oct/06/deloitte-to-pay-money-back-to-albanese-government-after-using-ai-in-440000-report>

S390 NPR, "McKinsey and Company to pay \$650M for role in opioid crisis" (13 Dec 2024). <https://www.npr.org/2024/12/13/nx-s1-5155962/mckinsey-purdue-opioid-prosecution-doj>

S407 Deloitte UK, "Deloitte UK publishes 2026 financial results (full text incl. notes to editors)" (2026-09-30). <https://www.deloitte.com/uk/en/about/press-room/deloitte-uk-publishes-2026-financial-results.html>